

LCD MONITORS

17-Inch LCD Monitors

Samsung 740N

Specifications

Viewable area: 17 inches; resolution: 1280 x 1024, aspect ratio: normal; pixel pitch: 0.264 mm; brightness: 300 cd/m²; contrast ratio: 600:1; interface: D-Sub; dimensions: 36.6 x 39.1 x 20 cm; power consumption: 34 W

Our Verdict

The Samsung 740N's response time of just 8

ms means it is good for gaming and movies. It can be adjusted vertically, and the VESA mounting option lets you hang it on a wall. Brightness and contrast ratio are good, the colours are vivid, the image is crisp, the viewing angle is wide. A power consumption of 34 W means considerable power savings.



Runner-Up: NU QL-711V

19-Inch LCD Monitors

NU L921G

Specifications

Viewable area: 19 inches; resolution: 1280 x 1024, aspect ratio: normal; pixel pitch: 0.294 mm, brightness: 320 cd/m²; contrast Ratio: 600:1; interface: D-Sub/DVI-D; dimensions: 44.8 x 44.7 x 19.3 cm; power consumption: 50 W

Our Verdict

"Good things come at a price." Not so in the case of the NU L921G. This 19-inch LCD is sturdy and weigh just 5.3 kg, less than most others in its category. It also has the smallest dimensions and footprint. It can be swivelled vertically but not horizontally. It has inbuilt

speakers, just in case. D-Sub as well as DVI-D connectors are provided for digital video signal transmission.

The brightness and the contrast ratio make viewing on this monitor a delight. A low response time of 8 ms and large viewing angles make it suitable for gaming as well as movies. Power consumption is 50 W, which again is quite low. In the end, it was the price tag that was the deciding factor in the NU L921G winning the Zero1 Award for 19-inch LCD monitors this year.



Runner-Up: Asus PW191

LINUX DISTRIBUTIONS

SuSE Linux 10.1

Our Verdict

If there is one Linux distro we'd bet our money on, it would be SuSE! With Novell's takeover of SuSE, things have simply moved several notches up.

With SuSE Linux 10.1, Novell has set a new benchmark in terms of look and feel. The interface is simply fantastic—well-thought-out grouping of menus, easy access to regularly-used applications, and an eye-pleasing Desktop.

YAST (Yet Another Setup Tool) makes installing SuSE Linux a painless affair; even disk partitioning, custom installation, etc. can be easily done by a novice. Hardware detection is on the better side, but could have been better.

The Beagle search engine makes searching for file a breeze, and YAST ensures application installation is easy. Automatic updates keep the system up to date with minimal user intervention. XGL X Server gives SuSE a user interface that has serious potential to rival the upcoming Vista and Apple's Mac OS X.

These features apart, what makes SuSE our choice for the best Linux distro is the ecosystem that Novell has built around it. Whether you need it for Desktop or server or both, Novell has products that integrate well to offer a complete solution.

Runner-Up: Ubuntu Linux

